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Purpose

This policy defines how passwords must be created and protected on company systems.

Scope

This document applies to employees based in the United States. It is owned by Nicole Herring and is effective from 2025-02-09.

Policy Rules

Passwords must be at least 14 characters long and must not reuse any of the last 5 passwords.

Passwords for privileged accounts must be changed every 120 days.

Multi-factor authentication is mandatory for email, VPN and every admin system.

Passwords must never be shared, written down or stored in plain text files.

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Procedure

1. Open the self-service password portal.
2. Verify your identity with your authenticator app.
3. Enter a new password that meets the length rule.
4. Sign out and sign in again on all your devices.

Escalation

If you suspect that your password was exposed, change it immediately and report it to the IT service desk.

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Contacts

Send questions about this document by email to it-help@company.local.

Document Control

Under Password Policy (United States) (version 2), the standard limit is 270 days. This is the maximum number of days between two checks of the document by its owner.

Version 2 replaces version 1. Values and thresholds were revised in the latest yearly check.